

MINI PCs

The size cannot be said to be an indicator of the performance that these devices are capable of

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Like any computer purchase that you'd undertake even Mini-PCs need careful usage scenario analysis before you lighten your wallet. Unfortunately, here in India we don't have as many options as we'd like to when it comes to these devices. They may be termed "Mini" but they can pack pretty much the same amount of power than the average computer does.

For tasks like browsing and running spreadsheets you can make do with an AMD E-Series or an Intel Celeron series CPU based mini-PC while moderate tasks may require an A8-5xxxM APU or an Intel Core i5 4200U CPU. However, if you want a SFF computer with a really beefy processor then go for the Intel Core i7 - 4770R or a Core i7 alternative. But you need to

focus on the suffix attached to these processors since they sometimes end up being low powered variants which really don't deserve the respect that the "i7" tag brings on. Along with the CPU, another important thing to cover is the memory and most mini-PCs come with just one DIMM and the performance difference between single-channel memory and dual-channel memory can be as great as 17%.

Mini-PCs rarely have discrete graphics cards, it's often either a Intel HD 4xxx/ Iris Pro or AMD's GCN which is better than Intel's offering. There are a few exceptions like the Gigabyte Brix, which is unfortunately not available in India at the moment and one particular Brix SKU that comes with a GTX 760 definitely takes the cake.

Since we're talking about mini-PCs, size definitely matters. A slim mini-PC won't have a powerful PC or GPU since those things heat up a lot. VESA mounts are another thing to consider since you can attach compatible mini-PCs onto your monitor. If your mini-PC isn't slim or is awkwardly shaped then it will throw your monitor off-balance.

Do keep in mind that mini PCs with lower end configurations often lack multiple USB 3.0 ports or don't have any to start with. The same goes for storage. Paying more gets you an M.2 SSD while entry-level SKUs start off with a 500 GB HDD running at 5400 RPM. You might as well get an 120 GB SSD for about ₹5,000 and give your mini-PC a shot in the arm. **d**

TOP

MINI PC



GIGABYTE BRIX BX15G-760

Having a desktop GTX 760 is something very few SFF computers can boast of



LENOVO THINKCENTRE M73

Variety along with great build quality is what the ThinkCentre brings to the table



INTEL NUC D54250WYK

Intel's 4th Gen NUC isn't behind the others in the arena in terms of price or performance



MAC MINI 2012

Rumours say that the 2014 refresh of the Mac Mini will be powered by a Core i7 4790

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